

DAMAGING EVIDENCE
A satellite grab of the Bholari air base before (left) and after (right) the Indian missile strike on May 10 that punched a hole through a hangar

DEFENCE | OPERATION SINDOOR

THE RED LINES GET SHARPER

A YEAR ON FROM THE CONFLICT, OPERATION SINDOOR HAS LED INDIA TO ADOPT A TECH-DRIVEN MILITARY MODERNISATION, WHILE PAKISTAN HAS BEEN JOLTED INTO MENDING THE CRACKS IN ITS OPERATIONAL READINESS AND COMMAND STRUCTURE

BY PRADIP R. SAGAR

Operation Sindoor, which began with India's missile strikes on nine terrorist hubs in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK) and its Punjab province, has just had its first anniversary. What lessons were learnt by the two adversaries from this 88-hour-long face-off over four intense days (May 7-10)? Airpower and air defences (AD), along with long-range artillery, were key factors, and electronic warfare (EW) and coordination between fighter aircraft, ground radars and Airborne Warning and Control System (AWACS) aircraft made this a truly smart war. Another new element was the introduction of asymmetric warfare tactics, with low-cost drones as well as cyber-attacks used by Pakistan, which were repelled effectively by India. After the first day, when Pakistan claimed to have shot down Indian fighter jets, the conflict swung in India's favour, and Pakistan had no answer to the barrage of Indian